

BULLY PREVENTION

What Is Bullying?

Bullying is repeated, intentional behavior that causes harm, fear, or discomfort to another person where there is an imbalance of power (physical, social, emotional, or digital).
Bullying vs Conflict: Conflict is a disagreement between equals; bullying involves ongoing harm and power imbalance.

Types of Bullying

1. Verbal Bullying

Using words to hurt: insults, teasing, name-calling, threats.

2. Physical Bullying

Harming the body or property: hitting, pushing, tripping, damaging belongings.

3. Prejudicial Bullying

Targeting someone because of identity or background (race, gender, disability, beliefs).

4. Relational Aggression

Harming relationships or reputation: spreading rumors, exclusion, manipulation.

5. Cyberbullying

Bullying through digital platforms: texts, social media, images, online posts.

6. Sexual Bullying (Informational)

Unwanted comments, pressure, or actions of a sexual nature that make someone uncomfortable.

Differences to Know

Flirting vs Sexual Harassment

Flirting: Mutual, respectful, welcome.

Harassment: Unwanted, persistent, makes someone feel unsafe or pressured.

Why Cyberbullying Is Different

Can be anonymous

Spreads quickly

Follows the victim everywhere

Harder to escape

Signs Someone May Be Being Bullied

Sudden withdrawal or sadness

Fear of school or activities

Unexplained injuries or lost items

Changes in sleep, appetite, or grades

Avoiding devices or being anxious online

Roles in a Bullying Situation (The Bully Circle)

Bully – initiates harm

Target/Victim – receives harm

Assistants – help the bully

Reinforcers – encourage by watching/laughing

Bystanders – see but do nothing

Defenders – support the target

Four Basic Rules of Bully Prevention

1. We will not bully others.
2. We will try to help those who are bullied.
3. We will include those who are left out.
4. We will tell a trusted adult if bullying is happening.

How to Protect Yourself

From Relational Aggression

Build strong friendships

Don't spread rumors

Speak up calmly

From Cyberbullying

Save evidence

Block/report offenders

Tell a trusted adult

From Sexual Bullying

Set clear boundaries

Get help immediately

Stay in safe spaces

Responding to Bullying (Safe Strategies)

Seek supportive friends

Maintain self-control

Ignore when safe

Avoid unsafe situations

Do not react emotionally

Be confident

Get adult help

Reporting Cyberbullying – Steps

1. Collect evidence

2. Report to parents/school

3. Report to service providers

4. Report to law enforcement if safety is at risk

Long-Term Consequences

For Victims

Anxiety, low self-esteem, fear

For Bullies

Relationship problems

Discipline or legal trouble

Ongoing behavior issues

Christian Perspective on Bullying

Bullying contradicts Christ's teaching of love, kindness, and respect for others.

Bible References

Deuteronomy 31:6 – Be strong and courageous

Proverbs 12:18 – Words can wound or heal

James 3:1–11 – Power of the tongue

Ephesians 4:29 – Speak words that build up

Mark 12:31 – Love your neighbor

Biblical Examples

David & His Brothers (1 Samuel 17:28–29): Words used to discourage

Joseph & His Brothers (Genesis 37): Jealousy and mistreatment

Mary & Judas (John 12:1–7): Harsh criticism and misunderstanding

Building Healthy Self-Worth

Self-acceptance: Valuing who you are

Self-esteem: Healthy confidence

Personal identity: Knowing your values

These protect against bullying and help others too.

Becoming Part of the Solution

Stand up kindly

Support victims

Promote inclusion

Commit to prevention rules

"I can" and "I will" actions help create a safe community.